

Component 3: Practical performance

Content

Students will be required to perform in one physical activity, in the role of either player/performer or coach. They will be required to demonstrate their skills while under pressure, in conditioned practice and a formal/competitive situation. Students must choose and perform one physical activity from the set list on pages 26 and 27.

Students should be taught to make relevant and appropriate links between their learning in Components 1 and 2 and use this to benefit their performances in the physical activities.

Students are required to demonstrate their ability to:

- perform a range of skills and techniques in physical activity
- make decisions, implement strategies, tactics and/or compositional ideas, and apply knowledge and understanding of rules and regulations while performing physical activity
- apply knowledge and understanding of theories, concepts, principles and methods to physical activity and performance.

General performance skills

Students should be aware of and apply appropriate and relevant physical attributes and psychological elements to the demands of their chosen activities.

Students must demonstrate appropriate levels of fitness in order to perform adequately.

Students must be aware of and apply appropriate and relevant rules/laws of the activity that they are performing. Students must perform their chosen activities safely. If they do not, then the teacher must intervene.

Physical activity list

The list below contains the permitted physical activities that students must select from. This list has been set by the Department for Education. Any changes or additions to the activities will in the first instance be indicated on our website. The rules in the right hand column provide further clarification as to the scope of a physical activity.

Physical activity	Rules
Acrobatic gymnastics*	
Amateur boxing	
Association football	Cannot be five-a-side.
Athletics	Can be assessed in one event from the disciplines of either Track or Field (including 5K and 10K track* and cross country*). Race walking is not a permitted Athletics event.
Badminton	
Basketball	Cannot be 'street basketball'.
BMX cycling*	Racing only, not tricks.
Canoeing	
Cricket	
Cycling	Track or road cycling.
Dance	Acceptable dances include: ballet, ballroom, contemporary/modern, cultural (includes hip-hop, Irish, Indian, jazz, Latin), folk and street.
Diving	Platform diving.
Equestrian	Can be assessed in either show jumping, cross country or dressage.
Field hockey	
Figure skating*	Men's and ladies' singles or team.
Futsal*	
Gaelic football	
Golf	
Gymnastics	Floor routines and apparatus.
Handball	
Hurling	
Ice hockey*	
Inline Roller hockey*	
Kayaking	
Lacrosse	
Netball	
Rock climbing	Can be indoor or outdoor.

Physical activity	Rules
Rowing	
Rugby league	Cannot be tag rugby.
Rugby union	Can be assessed as sevens or fifteen a side. Cannot be tag rugby.
Sailing*	Crew-based events or single-handed dinghy. Royal Yachting Association recognised sailing-boat classes only. Students must perform as helmsman.
Sculling	Team* or singles.
Skiing	Outdoor/indoor on snow. Must not be on dry slopes.
Snowboarding	Outdoor/indoor on snow. Must not be on dry slopes.
Squash	
Swimming	Not synchronised swimming.
Table tennis	
Tennis	
Trampolining	
Triathlon*	Sprint only.
Volleyball	
Water polo*	
Windsurfing*	
Specialist physical activity**	Rules
Blind cricket	
Boccia	
Goalball	
Powerchair football	
Polybat	
Table cricket	
Wheelchair basketball	
Wheelchair rugby	

* These activities are available for first teaching from September 2020 and first certification from Summer 2022.

** The specialist activities are available only to those students with a physical disability, and in line with entry criteria set out by that activity's National Governing Body. If a student is classified as eligible, then they should be assessed in the classification based on the relevant activity's National Governing Body classification criteria.

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- It is recommended that the minimum duration for the student activity is approximately 54 hours, combining preparation and the assessed performance.
- The assessment is out of 40 marks.
- Marks must be submitted at the end of the course.
- The assessment will be internally marked by the centre and externally moderated by Pearson.
- The assessment consists of students completing one physical activity from the set list on pages 26–27 of this specification.
- Students can be assessed in either the role of player/performer or coach.
- As a player/performer, students will be assessed against set assessment criteria which can be found in the *Practical Performance Assessment Criteria*. There are separate assessment criteria for each physical activity. Generic assessment criteria are on pages 31–35 of this specification.
- As a coach, students will be assessed against set assessment criteria which can be found on pages 36–41 of this specification and in the *Practical Performance Assessment Criteria*.
- Centres must ensure that marks for each performance submitted are valid for the series in which they are submitted.
- The activities with a single asterisk in the set list of physical activities on pages 26–27 of this specification are available for first teaching from September 2020 and first certification from Summer 2022.

Practical performance setting

Students should choose their physical activity with the support and advice of their teacher.

Assessing the physical activities

Teachers must design physical activities to enable all students to demonstrate their skills and techniques in order to meet the assessment criteria. Formal/competitive activities are defined as, for example and where appropriate, performances in a full-sided game and performances in front of an audience/judges. If students are participating in a team game then a full-sided game must be demonstrated in the assessment of the activity. Where it becomes apparent to the teacher assessing that students are not being given the opportunity to demonstrate their full range of skills during a formal/competitive game situation, the teacher may intervene to create an opportunity for a conditioned practice (for example by permitting defenders to switch sides) to allow students to demonstrate their appropriate skills. This condition applies predominately to team game activities (such as football, rugby union, rugby league, hockey, lacrosse, basketball, camogie, hurling, handball, netball, volleyball) but may also apply to other activities where necessary.

It is recommended that the minimum duration for the student activity is approximately